

operations. The RROD is an error code by Microsoft, meant to signal that there has been a hardware failure.

While this error code is usually caused by failure of one or more hardware components, it also can indicate that the console is not receiving enough power from the power supply, which can either be due to a faulty power supply or if the power supply cable is not fully inserted into the console.

Here is an excerpt from Wikipedia with validated referrals: "A source that has been identified as a team leader and key architect in the creation of the Xbox and Xbox 360 and a founding member of the Xbox team provided insight as to the high rate of failures. The interviews suggest that Xbox 360 units that fail early in their life do so because of problems in the system design, parts supply, material reliability, and manufacturing issues as well as a system not tolerant to faults. These issues were alleged to be the end results of the decisions of management in Microsoft's Xbox team and inadequate testing resources prior to the console's release. A second source cited that, at one time, there was just a 32 per cent yield of one of the test production runs. 68 of every 100 test units were found to be defective."

In February 2008, during the Game Developers Conference 2008, Microsoft announced that the "Failure rate has officially dropped", but without mentioning any specifics. The same month, electronics warranty provider SquareTrade published an examination of 1,040 Xbox 360s and said that they suffered from a failure rate of 16.4 per cent (one in six). Of the 171 failures, 60 per cent were due to a general hardware failure. And of the remaining 40 per cent which were not covered by the extended warranty, 18 per cent were disk read errors, 13 per cent were video card failures, 13 per cent were hard drive freezes, 10 per cent were power problems and 7 per cent were disk tray malfunctions. SquareTrade also stated that its estimates are likely much lower than reality due to the time span of the sample (six to ten months), the eventual failure of many consoles that did not fail within this time span and the fact that many owners did not deal with SquareTrade and had their consoles repaired directly through Microsoft via the much publicised extended RROD warranty.



Just like the Blue Screen of Death plagued Windows users for years, the Red Ring of Death is the Xbox 360 user's nightmare

2.3 Nintendo Wii

Nintendo had been making video game consoles before Microsoft and Sony even made it big in their respective fields. From the original Nintendo Entertainment System to the GameCube, the company has been the most consistent console